

1. Dear LaTeX,

It has been **eleven years**. Eleven years of `\begin{document}`, of mysterious vertical-mode errors, of citations rendered as `[?]` because BibTeX had Opinions about the .bib file I had not yet finished saving. Eleven years of you greeting every PDF I make with the same Computer Modern serif that everyone, everywhere, immediately recognises as *a sad student wrote this*.

I have moved on. The new arrangement embeds **real** TrueType outlines, Noto Sans in this case, through a Type 0 CID font with a `/ToUnicode` CMap, which is a sentence I should not have to know, but here we are. Copy-paste round-trips. Search works. The Polish co-author gets **Łódź** instead of *L*, a space, and an apostrophe. The Czech reviewer gets **Příliš žluťoučký kůň** without three preamble lines of `\usepackage{}` ritual. The Russian correspondents get **Привет, Мозаика**. The Greek desk gets **Καλημέρα, κόσμε**. None of them get an email from me asking which encoding their text editor was using when they sent the draft.

The math, fine, you were good at math. I will give you that. But I am also done feeling like a fraud for pasting a single $\leq$ into a paragraph and being forced to load `amsmath`, `amssymb`, and a third package whose name I have forgotten because the universe took it from me. Mosaic shapes math operators ($\leq \geq \neq \sqrt{\partial \Sigma}$) through automatic per-glyph fallback to the bundled Noto Sans Math cut, mid-word, mid-sentence, with no `#set text(font: ...)`, no `\usepackage{}`, no `$ ... $`. The body face does not contain them; the fallback face does; the layout engine notices on its own and routes the cluster. The result reads like prose because it *is* prose; $\partial f / \partial x \neq 0$ sits in this line the same way "the" does.

My grievances, in no particular order except the one I wrote them in:

1. The error messages. **Especially** the one about `\par`.
2. The figure handling. One `#figure(image: "...", caption: "...")` block here, and forty minutes of `\begin{figure}[!htbp]` float-placement bargaining there. I have aged out of caring which letters do which.
3. The fi/fl ligatures, which you handled but never let me actually see without diagnostic incantations. Mine ship as one glyph in the PDF the way the typographer intended. Copy "figment" or "flicker" out of this document and paste it somewhere; the ligature collapses back into the source codepoints on the way out. It is shaping, not a font hack.

Sub-grievances, indented because that is also a thing now:

- The way you treated quotation marks. We have em dashes — like that — without three hyphens, and no, I will not be installing a package for it.
- The way `verbatim` and `code` could never quite agree about whitespace.
- Yes, I know it was the package's fault.
- I do not care whose fault it was.
- The bibliography. I am still angry about the bibliography.

1.1. Some good news

Italic still means italic. **Bold** still means bold. They route through the real designed cuts of Noto Sans, not a faux- slant transformation, and the same is true in Cyrillic (*күрсүө* , **жирный**) and Greek (*πλάγια* , **έντονα**). If anyone needs the Adobe Core 14 fonts (you, mostly, when you are nostalgic), `#set text(font: "Helvetica")` is still there. It will look exactly like the 1985 you remember.

I am attaching a screenshot of what the README promised, so we can compare it later with what shipped. You will notice it does not say `\documentclass{article}` anywhere.



Figure 1: Exhibit A. A PNG, appearing here, below the sentence that references it, as God intended and LaTeX refused.

Yours, with twenty-three open browser tabs of Stack Exchange threads from 2007,
Mosaic